



Agoura Westlake AYSO

Evaluation Day Coach / Evaluator Guide



Meeting Goal

Align coaches and evaluators before Evaluation Day so players feel safe, ratings are consistent, and the completed sheets give the region enough detail to build balanced teams.

Evaluation Focus

These evaluations are for Core level AYSO players. This is not tryouts; it is to help division commissioners make more balanced Fall teams.

Criteria	What To Look For
Technical Execution	Does the player stand out technically? Can they execute basic dribbling, ball control, passing and receiving, and/or ball striking?
Game Understanding	Do they spread out, move off the ball, recognize space/pressure, get goal side when defending, and anticipate the play?
Attitude & Behavior	Do they listen, interact well with teammates, show leadership or self-confidence, respond well to mistakes, concentrate, and stay coachable?
Mental + Physical Speed	Reaction time, acceleration, sprinting speed, and speed of decision making/execution.

30-Minute Zoom Flow

Time	Segment	Talking Points
0-3 min	Welcome	Thank coaches/evaluators and explain that the goal is balanced teams and a positive player experience.
3-7 min	Evaluation philosophy	Every player makes a team. We are evaluating for balance, not cutting players.
7-12 min	How to use the sheet	Walk through player name, tryout #, 1-4 overall rating, S/W division-wide notes, and comments.
12-18 min	Rating calibration	Explain what 1, 2, 3, and 4 mean so evaluators use the same standard.
18-24 min	Field/session flow	Review the 40-minute activity sequence and what to watch for during each section.
24-28 min	Privacy + logistics	Keep sheets covered, confirm field assignments, and explain where completed sheets go.
28-30 min	Questions	Answer questions and confirm next steps before Evaluation Day.

Agenda Overview

#	Topic	Talking Points
1	Welcome + Purpose	Evaluation Day helps us create balanced teams. This is not a tryout; every player makes a team.
2	What To Watch	Pay attention to how players compete, whether they thrive, and whether they make an impact in the game.
3	Evaluator Role	Rate what you see, keep comments useful, protect the sheet from players, and turn in completed sheets before leaving.
4	Evaluation Sheet	Each sheet has 12 player rows: player name, tryout #, overall rating, division-wide note, and additional comments.

#	Topic	Talking Points
5	Rating Scale	Use 1-4 for overall rating. 4 is the best rating, like an Amazon review. 3 and 2 are the middle; 1 is not ready yet.
6	Division-Wide Notes	Use S for strongest and W for weakest only when a player clearly stands out at either end of the division.
7	Comments	Write a specific comment for every player. These comments help separate the middle group and create balanced teams.
8	New Players	Ask who is playing soccer for the first time. If they do not want to raise their hand, invite them to tell you separately.
9	Field Flow	Review the 40-minute plan: welcome, warm-up, technical activity, 1v1/evasion, small-sided game, final notes.
10	Privacy + Turn-In	Keep a blank page on top when players are nearby. Turn sheets in to Coach Corinne or the trainer before leaving.

Suggested 40-Minute Session Plan

Time	Activity	What Evaluators Should Watch For
0-3 min	Welcome + framing	Tell players this is not a tryout; everyone makes a team. Ask who is brand-new to soccer and offer a private option.
3-8 min	Ball mastery warm-up	Dribbling, turns, changes of direction. Look for comfort on the ball, coordination, and confidence.
8-16 min	Passing / receiving	Simple partner or small-group passing. Look for first touch, accuracy, movement, and ability to listen/apply coaching.
16-24 min	1v1 / attacking-defending	Short 1v1s or evasion games. Look for competitiveness, bravery, speed, balance, and defensive effort.
24-36 min	Small-sided game	3v3/4v4/5v5 depending on numbers. This is the best place to rate soccer sense, effort, spacing, and decision-making.
36-40 min	Final notes + transition	Finish ratings while players rotate out. Keep a blank page over the sheet and hand completed sheets to Corinne/trainer.

Rating Calibration

Rating	Meaning	Use When You See
4	Top / better players	Clearly above the group. Impacts the game, confident, athletic, makes good decisions, or has strong soccer skill.
3	Middle / solid	Comfortable player who contributes and understands many basic game moments. Add comments to distinguish from other middle players.
2	Middle / developing	Some ability but inconsistent. May need support with confidence, rules, ball control, or positioning.
1	Not ready yet	Very new, hesitant, or struggling with basic movement, rules, ball control, or involvement. Be honest and objective.

Ideal Comments

Best comments are short, objective, and useful for team balancing. Examples:

- Aggressive, quick to the ball, eager to learn, but lacks a bit technically.
- Great speed and technique, works hard, team player, recovers well when beaten.
- Athletic, energetic, engages in the play, good movement off the ball, creates space.
- Effective with good ability, great attitude, understands the game, likes to compete.
- Very slow, no technique, kicks the ball with no purpose.
- Fast, but poor attitude, lacks technique, does not listen well.
- Poor technique, uninvolved in the game, needs significant support.

Avoid These Comments

- Vague: good, bad, ok, weak.
- Harsh labels or anything a parent/player should not read.
- Long paragraphs. Keep it quick and useful for team formation.
- Comments about personality unless it affects soccer participation, like shy/hesitant/confident.

Important Reminders

- Use comments to help balance teams, not to write full player reviews.
- Rate the player compared with the division, not compared with travel players or older age groups.
- If unsure between two ratings, use the comment box to explain the nuance. Use + or - when helpful.
- For first-time players, note soccer experience and whether they understood the basic rules after explanation.
- Write your name under evaluator, fill out the date, and note age group and gender on every sheet.
- Complete overall ranking and write specific comments for every single player.
- Protect the sheet when players come over. Keep a blank sheet on top.

Closing

Thank evaluators, confirm field assignments, confirm where each group reports, and remind everyone to turn in completed sheets to Coach Corinne or the trainer on their field before leaving.